

Congress in Bombay Province in 1926 A.D. After this, Workers and Peasants Party was formed in United Province in 1928 A.D. and in Punjab by name of Kirti Kisan Party. In the conference of these Workers and Peasant parties of different provinces held in Calcutta in December, 1928 A.D., 'All India Workers and Peasant Party' was formed as pan India organisation. Hence statement 1 is incorrect.

The purpose of this party was to work within the Congress to make it a more revolutionary party and to organize the general public. Thus, the second statement is correct. Hence, the correct answer is (d).

Rowlatt Act and Jallianwala Bagh Massacre (1919)

Government constituted a committee under the Chairmanship of Justice Sydney Rowlatt, in 1917 A.D. with the objective of making an effective plan to suppress the increasing revolutionary activities. Based on the recommendations made by this committee, an Act was passed in March 1919 A.D. which empowered to arrest anyone anytime and detain them without any ongoing trial against them. This Act was also called as an act of **No Vakil, No Appeal, No Dalil**. Rowlatt Act was passed during the tenure of Lord Chelmsford (1916-1921 A.D.) in 1919 A.D. Gandhiji used three stages - Home Rule League, Khilafat and Satyagraha Sabha for his Rowlatt Satyagraha.

*First bold step of Gandhiji in All India politics was the **Rowlatt Satyagraha**. *On 13th, April 1919 A.D., a meeting was called to protest against the arrest of two popular leaders of Punjab, **Dr. Saifuddin Kitchlew** and **Dr. Satyapal**. The meeting was organized in **Jallianwala Bagh Amritsar** on the day of Baisakhi. **Brigadier General Reginald Edward Harry Dyer** ordered to open fire on unarmed peaceful gathering killing nearly 1000 individuals. After the Massacre at Jallianwala Bagh, Rabindranath Tagore returned the title of Knight granted by the English Government. ***Shankaran Nair** resigned from the Viceroy's Executive Council in protest against the massacre. ***Hunter Commission** was constituted by the British Government to inquire into the incident of Jallianwala Bagh Massacre. **C.H. Sitalwad, Pt. Jagat Narayan** and **Sultan Ahmad Khan** were Indian member in this commission. The commission in its report presented in 1920 didn't find government guilty in this incident. It was said that disorder sometimes becomes revolt. That is why Martial law was compulsory and it is fully justifiable to open fire at that huge gathering. Also, this commission said that incident was just as an error in judgement of Dyer. *Brigadier General Dyer was expelled from duty for this incident but British newspaper presented him as the protector of British Empire and

British Lords of assembly praised him as the **Lion of British Empire**. For his services to Britain, he was given the **Sword of Honour**. In March 1940 A.D., a Revolutionary from Punjab **Udham Singh** killed the Lieutenant governor (of Punjab at the time of Massacre) **Sir Michael O' Dwyer** in London to avenge the Jallianwala Bagh killings. Gandhiji was given the task of writing the draft of the report of Congress Investigation Committee on Jallianwala Bagh Massacre. *Montague termed the Jallianwala Bagh Massacre as Preventive Killing.

1. During the Indian Freedom Struggle, why did the Rowlatt Act arouse popular indignation?

- (a) It curtailed the freedom of religion
- (b) It suppressed the traditional Indian education.
- (c) It authorized the Government to imprison people without trial
- (d) It curbed the trade union activities.

I.A.S. (Pre) 2009

Ans. (c)

During the viceroyalty of Lord Chelmsford, a sedition committee was appointed by the Government in 1917 A.D. with Justice Rowlatt, which made certain recommendations to curb sedition activity in India. The Rowlatt Act, 1919 A.D., gave unbridled powers to the Government to arrest and imprison suspects without trial. The Act caused a wave of anger among all sections of the society. A well-known description of the bill at that time was: No Vakil, No appeal, No Daleel which means No lawyer, No appeal, No Plea.

2. The Rowlatt Act was passed to :

- (a) Bring about Agrarian Reforms
- (b) Curtail the National and Revolutionary Activities
- (c) Have a favourable 'Balance of Trade.'
- (d) Put Second World War criminals on trial

Jharkhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2013

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of above question.

3. When was the Rowlatt Act passed?

- (a) 1909
- (b) 1919
- (c) 1930
- (d) 1942

U.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 1993

48th to 52nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of above question.

4. The Rowlatt Act aimed at :

- (a) Compulsory economic support to war efforts
- (b) Imprisonment without trial and summary procedures for trial

- (c) Suppression of the Khilafat Movement
- (d) Imposition of restrictions on freedom of the press

I.A.S. (Pre) 2012

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of above question.

5. With reference to Rowlatt Satyagraha, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. The Rowlatt Act was based on the recommendations of the 'Sedition Committee.'
 2. In Rowlatt Satyagraha, Gandhiji tried to utilize the Home Rule League.
 3. Demonstrations against the arrival of Simon Commission coincided with Rowlatt Satyagraha.
- Select the correct answer using the code given below.
- (a) 1 only
 - (b) 1 and 2 only
 - (c) 2 and 3 only
 - (d) 1, 2 and 3

I.A.S. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (b)

Rowlatt Act also known as black Act (termed by Gandhiji) was a legislative Act passed by the Imperial Legislative Council in 1919 A.D. The Act allowed the British Government to arrest any Indian without any trial or warrant. The Act was based on Sedition Committee. In Rowlatt Satyagraha, Gandhiji tried to utilize the Home Rule League. Simon Commission reached India on February 03, 1928 A.D. which resulted in strikes in major cities and towns and it was welcomed with the popular slogan 'Simon ! Go Back'

6. Who was the Viceroy of India when the Rowlatt Act was passed?

- (a) Lord Irwin
- (b) Lord Reading
- (c) Lord Chelmsford
- (d) Lord Wavell

I.A.S. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (c)

Lord Chelmsford (1916-1921 A.D.) was the Viceroy of India when the Rowlatt Act was passed.

7. In whose Viceroyalty the 'Rowlatt Act' was passed?

- (a) Lord Harding II
- (b) Lord Reading
- (c) Lord Chelmsford
- (d) Lord Minto II

U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Pre) 2014

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question.

8. Indian National Congress opposed the Rowlatt Act because it aimed-

- (a) To limit the individual liberty
- (b) To ban on Indian National Congress

- (c) To enlarge the communal delegations
- (d) To imprison national leaders charging the traitors to the nation

41st B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (a)

In March, 1919 A.D., the Imperial Legislative Council of British India passed the Rowlatt Act. The Imperial Legislative Council passed this law so they could try certain cases without a jury decision and detain people without fair and proper trial. Mostly the Indian public disliked this Act because it aimed to limit individual liberty.

9. Consider the following statements about The Rowlatt Satyagraha.

- (1) The Rowlatt Satyagraha turned out to be the first all-India struggle against the British government although it was largely restricted to cities.
- (2) The Rowlatt Act curbed fundamental rights such as the freedom of expression and strengthened police powers.

Choose the right option given below :

- (a) Both the statements (1) and (2) are correct
- (b) Only the statement (1) is correct
- (c) Only the statement (2) is correct
- (d) None of the above

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (a)

Rowlatt Act was passed by the Imperial legislative council in 1919 A.D. The act was an effective plan to suppress the increasing revolutionary activities in country. It curbed fundamental rights such as the freedom of expression and put severe restrictions on press. The act strengthened police powers so much that anybody could be arrested without any trial against them. In response Gandhiji started Rowlatt Satyagrah (1919 A.D.) which was although restricted to cities but turned to be the first all-India struggle against the British government.

10. The first venture of Gandhi in all-India politics was the:

- (a) Non-Cooperation Movement
- (b) Rowlatt Satyagraha
- (c) Champaran Movement
- (d) Dandi March

I.A.S. (Pre) 1999

Ans. (b)

Every movement started by Gandhiji helped Indian Nationalism to attain an unprecedented height. The Movements conceived by Gandhiji like Champaran Peasant Movement (1917 A.D.), Ahmedabad Mill Workers Movement (1918 A.D.), Kheda Peasant Movement (1918 A.D.) were limited to the specific

issue of a particular section of the society. The scope of the area was also very limited. But Rowlatt Satyagraha (1919 A.D.) against the censorship of freedom of press and detention without trial was proactively joined by all the sections of the society. Sentiments of the aggrieved common people were addressed. Knitting of people from all religions, all castes, all age groups, and both the genders in the Nationalist Movement had a distinguished characteristic of the Rowlatt Satyagraha. National newspapers, political journals, etc. made Gandhi a popular figure. This was the first all India level Movement launched by Mahatma Gandhi.

11. Who suggested launching of no tax campaign as a protest against Rowlatt Act?

- (a) Abul Kalam Azad (b) Gandhiji
(c) Rabindranath Tagore (d) Swami Shraddhanand

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2008

Ans. (d)

The Rowlatt Act was also called as an Act without a lawyer, without appeal, without a plea or Black Law. According to this Act, the British Government was free to arrest and imprison suspects without trial. In protest to this Act, Swami Shraddhanand suggested starting the Movement with the non-payment of Lagaan (Rent).

12. The Anarchical and Revolutionary Crime Act (1919) was popularly known as the:

- (a) Rowlatt Act (b) Pitt's India Act
(c) Indian Arms Act (d) Ilbert Bill

I.A.S. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (a)

The Anarchical and Revolutionary Crime Act was popularly known as the Rowlatt Act. The Act was passed on the recommendations of a Committee under the chairmanship of Justice Sidney Rowlatt.

13. Which important event immediately preceded Jallianwala Bagh massacre?

- (a) Non-Cooperation Movement
(b) Enactment of Rowlatt Act
(c) Communal Award
(d) Arrival of Simon Commission

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2012

Ans. (b)

Rowlatt Act was enacted in March, 1919 A.D. In protest to this Act Gandhi had organized a country-wide strike on April 06, 1919 A.D. Brigadier General Dyer orchestrated the brutal killing on April 13, 1919 A.D. at Jallianwala Bagh. Non-Cooperation Movement (start) took place in 1920 A.D., Communal Award in 1932 AD and Simon Commission came to India in 1928 A.D.

14. The massacre of the crowd at Jallianwala Bagh at Amritsar took place on :

- (a) May 5, 1918 (b) April 1, 1919
(c) April 13, 1919 (d) July 29, 1919

46th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2003

Ans. (c)

Jallianwala Bagh Massacre or Amritsar massacre was an important incident in the history of Indian Freedom Movement during the British rule. On April 13, 1919 the infamous Jallianwala Bagh incident took place. On that day a large crowd gathered in the enclosed ground of Jallianwala Bagh to protest against the Government's new repressive measures and to protest against the arrest of two famous leaders of Punjab Dr. Saifuddin Kitchlew and Dr. Satyapal. Others had come to attend the annual Baisakhi fair. Being outside from the city, many villagers were unaware of the martial law that had been imposed. Dyer entered the area, blocked the exit points, and opened fire on the crowd, killing thousands of people.

15. The Jallianwala Bagh Massacre happened in the context of which Gandhian Satyagraha?

- (a) Swadeshi Satyagraha (b) Rowlatt Satyagraha
(c) Bardoli Satyagraha (d) Individual Satyagraha
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2018

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of above question.

16. The year 1919 in Indian history is related to :

- (a) for the transfer of capital from Calcutta to Delhi
(b) for the tragedy of Jallianwala Bagh Massacre
(c) Partition of Bengal
(d) Khilafat Movement

38th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1992

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of above question.

17. Jallianwala Bagh Massacre took place in the city :

- (a) Meerut (b) Agra
(c) Amritsar (d) Lahore

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2010

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question.

18. General Dwyer name is associated with which of the following events?

- (a) Black Hole of Calcutta (b) Battle of Rani Durgavati
(c) Battle of 1857 (d) Jallianwala Bagh

M.P P.C.S. (Pre) 1993

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of above question.

19. During the Indian freedom struggle, a large unarmed crowd gathered in the Jallianwala Bagh at Amritsar on April 13, 1919 to protest against the arrest of:

- (a) Swami Shraddhanand and Mazharul Haq
- (b) Madan Mohan Malviya and Mohammad Ali Jinnah
- (c) Mahatma Gandhi and Abul Kalam Azad
- (d) Dr. Saifuddin Kitchlu and Dr. Satyapal

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2002

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of above question.

20. Why did people gather to demonstrate at Jallianwala Bagh?

- (a) To protest against the arrest of Gandhi and Lajpat Rai
- (b) To protest against the arrest of Kitchlu and Satyapal
- (c) To offer prayers on the Baisakhi Day
- (d) To protest against the arbitrarily of inhuman acts of the Punjab Government.

48th to 52nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of above question.

21. The person who returned his honour to the Indian Government on May 30, 1919 was –

- (a) Jamnalal Bajaj
- (b) Tej Bahadur Sapru
- (c) Mahatma Gandhi
- (d) Rabindranath Tagore

U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2004

U.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 2001

Ans. (d)

After the incident of Jallianwala Bagh (April 13, 1919 A.D.), Rabindranath Tagore returned his honour of 'Knighthood' to Indian Government on May 31, 1919 A.D. In a letter to the Governor-General, he wrote: "..... The time has come when badges of honour make our shame glaring in their incongruous context of humiliation and I for my part wish to stand shorn of all special distinctions by the side of those of my countrymen who, for their so-called insignificance, are liable to suffer degradations not fit for human beings....."

22. The name of the famous person of India who returned the Knighthood conferred on him by the British Government as a token of protest against the atrocities in Punjab in 1919 was:

- (a) Tej Bahadur Sapru
- (b) Ashutosh Mukherjee
- (c) Rabindra Nath Tagore
- (d) Syed Ahmed Khan

I.A.S. (Pre) 2004

Ans. (c)

Rabindra Nath Tagore returned his Knighthood to the British Government as a token of protest against the Jallianwala Bagh massacre in 1919 A.D.

23. As a means of protest against which of the following incident, Rabindranath Tagore gave up his honor of knighthood?

- (a) Partition of Bengal
- (b) Press Act of 1910
- (c) Jallianwala Bagh Massacre
- (d) Salt Law

U.P. U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2006

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question.

24. Rabindra Nath Tagore gave up his 'Knighthood' in protest to which one of the following?

- (a) Rowlatt Act
- (b) Massacre at Jallianwala Bagh
- (c) Simon Commission
- (d) Cripps Mission

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of above question.

25. Who returned the 'Knighthood' title to the British Government in reaction against Jallianwala Bagh Massacre ?

- (a) Rabindranath Tagore
- (b) Shankaran Nair
- (c) Md. Ali Jinnah
- (d) Rameshwar Singh

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of above Question.

26. Rabindranath Tagore gave up his 'Knighthood' because of

- (a) Brutal suppression of Civil Disobedience Movement
- (b) Execution of Bhagat Singh
- (c) Jallianwala Bagh Tragedy
- (d) Chauri Chaura Incident
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

65th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question.

27. Given below are two statements, one labelled as Assertion (A) and other as Reason (R) -

Assertion (A) : Rabindranath Tagore renounced Knighthood.

Reason (R): He wanted to participate in the Non-cooperation Movement.

Choose the correct answer from the code given below-
Code -

- (a) Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)
- (b) Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)

- (c) (A) is true but (R) is false
(d) (A) is false but (R) is true

U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Pre.) 2021

Ans (c)

Rabindranath Tagore renounced his Knighthood or sir in protest against Jallianwala Bagh Massacre and not in support of non-cooperation movement.

28. Who resigned from the membership of Viceroy's Executive Council as a protest against Jallianwala Bagh Massacre?

- (a) Mahatma Gandhi (b) Rabindranath Tagore
(c) Shankaran Nair (d) Jamnalal Bajaj

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2007

Ans. (c)

Shankaran Nair resigned from the Viceroy's Executive Council as a protest against the Jallianwala Bagh massacre.

29. Who among the following had resigned from the Viceroy's Executive Council protesting Jallianwala Bagh Massacre?

- (a) Rabindranath Tagore (b) Madan Mohan Malviya
(c) Sir Shankar Nair (d) All three above

U.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 2013

U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2013

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question.

30. Who among the following gave up the title of 'Sir' in protest against the Jallianwala Bagh incident?

- (a) Mahatma Gandhi (b) Jawaharlal Nehru
(c) Rabindranath Tagore (d) Tej Bahadur Sapru

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2012

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Mains) 2006

Ans. (c)

Rabindranath Tagore gave up the title of 'Sir' in protest against Jallianwala Bagh incident.

31. Select the correct sequence of the following events by using the codes given below:

1. Jallianwala Bagh Massacre
2. Dr. Satyapal's incarceration
3. Amritsar Congress Session, 1919

Code :

- (a) 2, 1, 3 (b) 1, 2, 3
(c) 2, 3, 1 (d) 3, 2, 1

U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2003

U.P. Lower Sub.(Spl.) (Pre) 2002

Ans. (a)

Saifuddin Kitchlu and Dr. Satyapal were popular leaders who were arrested by Deputy Commissioner of Amritsar on April 9, 1919 A.D. Jallianwala Bagh massacre took place on 13 April, 1919 A.D. and the Amritsar Session of the Congress was held in December, 1919 A.D.

32. The Hunter Committee was appointed after the:

- (a) Blackhole incident
(b) Jallianwala Bagh massacre
(c) Uprising of 1857
(d) Partition of Bengal

I.A.S. (Pre) 2001

Ans. (b)

The Government established a Disorders Inquiry Committee headed by Lord William Hunter, a Senator of College of Justice of Scotland. The Committee had 7 members 4 British and 3 Indians. It was set up to investigate the Jallianwala Bagh Tragedy. Before the Committee could publish its report, Congress put forward its view. This view criticized Dyer's act as inhuman and also said that there was no justification for the introduction of the martial law in Punjab. But the Hunter Report, as expected, saw the things differently. Although it condemned most of the decisions taken by Brigadier General Dyer, it agreed with the imposition of martial law in Punjab. It also criticized the method of Satyagraha adopted by Gandhi and held Gandhi partially responsible for "deteriorated" law and order situation. As a result, Dyer was sent to England relieved of his command. The British Government called Brigadier General Dyer 'Lion of British Empire' and gave 'Sword of Honour' for his service.

33. Who from the following killed Michael O' Dwyer responsible for Jallianwala Bagh massacre?

- (a) Prithvi Singh Azad (b) Sardar Kishan Singh
(c) Udham Singh (d) Sohan Singh Josh

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1994

45th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2001

Ans. (c)

On 13 March, 1940 A.D., at Caxton Hall in London, Udham Singh, an Indian Independence activist who had witnessed the events in Amritsar and was himself wounded, shot and killed Michael O'Dwyer, the British Lieutenant-Governor of Punjab at the time of the massacre, who had approved Dwyer's action and was believed to be the main planner.

34. Sir Michael O'Dwyer was shot dead on 13th March, 1940 in London by:

- (a) Madan Lal Dhillon (b) M.P.T. Acharya
(c) V.D. Savarkar (d) Udham Singh
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

60th to 62nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of above question.